

# SHEKHAR DASH

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## EDUCATION

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**University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC, USA 2026**

*Master of Arts, Educational Innovation, Technology & Entrepreneurship (MEITE)*

Specialization: Adaptive Learning Analytics

**Satyajit Ray Film & Television Institute, Kolkata, India 2016–2019**

*Postgraduate Diploma in Cinema — Direction & Screenplay Writing (3-Year PG)*

Fully funded ICCR Scholarship, Government of India

**Visva Bharati University (Tagore's University), Santiniketan, India 2009–2012**

*B.Mus (Hons), Drama and Theatre Arts*

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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**Professional Fellowship in Entrepreneurship, U.S. Department of State — Global Leaders Division Jan 2025**

Economic Empowerment: Emerging Leaders from South Asia; hosted by the University of Oklahoma's Gaylord College of Journalism

**ICCR Scholarship (Fully Funded), Indian Council for Cultural Relations, Government of India 2016**

Awarded to pursue postgraduate studies at Satyajit Ray Film & Television Institute, Kolkata

**Gold Medal, Secondary School Certificate (SSC), Sonali Bank PLC, Bangladesh 2004**

GPA 5.0 (Golden A+); ranked among approximately 3,000 of nearly 1 million national examinees

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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**Mathematics Potential Lab (MPL) — UNC Chapel Hill 2025–Present**

*Research Assistant — Supervisor: Dr. Jessica Rodrigues*

Project KEY (NSF CAREER Award #2237053, 2023–2028):

- Contribute to systematic journal analysis examining how mathematics-focused research is communicated to K–12 practitioners, with emphasis on students with disabilities and general education learners.
- Support design and evaluation of key abstracts — infographic-style research translation tools aimed at closing the persistent research-to-practice gap in mathematics education.
- Co-authoring an empirical research paper with Dr. Jessica Rodrigues on research dissemination and practitioner uptake in math education.

POD — Special Education Faculty Jobs Paired Open Database:

- Serve as data visualizer for a multi-year project tracking and analyzing special education faculty job postings across U.S. higher education institutions.
- Design data visualizations supporting both practitioner outreach and research reporting on national demand for special education faculty.

**"From Instruction to Interaction" — Graduate Research Project, MEITE Program, UNC Chapel Hill 2025–Present**

*Graduate Researcher*

- Lead an ongoing design-based research project exploring how AI- and XR-mediated embodied interactions can transform pedagogical practice, integrating learning analytics and interaction analysis.
- Presented poster and conference proceedings paper at SITE 2025 International Conference: "From Instruction to Interaction: Designing an Embodied, AI-Supported Learning Ecology."

**Montana App — Attention & Storytelling in Digital Learning, UNC Chapel Hill 2025–Present**

*Researcher & Learning Experience Designer — in collaboration with Dr. Todd Cherner*

- Designed and prototyped an educational app that detects learner mind-wandering and delivers story-driven re-engagement interventions, grounded in cognitive science.
- Planning empirical study with Dr. Todd Cherner investigating how storytelling functions as an attention-retrieval mechanism in digital learning environments.

## LEARNING EXPERIENCE & INSTRUCTIONAL DESIGN

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### **VER Coaching — VR Athlete Performance Lab, Chapel Hill, NC 2025–2026**

*Data Analysis & Media Production Intern*

- Analyzed VR-generated athlete performance data and designed visualizations communicating actionable training insights to coaching staff.
- Produced brand-building video content across multiple formats to support audience development and establish the startup's identity.

### **Marc Cuban Foundation — GenAI Evaluation Tool, UNC Chapel Hill 2025**

*Instructional Designer & Prototype Developer*

- Co-designed LLM Math Sec, an assessment instrument enabling K–12 educators to critically evaluate generative AI tools for mathematics lesson planning.
- Built interactive prototype using Articulate 360 and Figma; presented findings and recommendations to foundation stakeholders.

### **Intuition — Analytical Thinking App, UNC Chapel Hill 2025–Present**

*Learning Experience Designer*

- Designing an educational app aimed at developing learners' analytical thinking capacities through structured, scaffolded interaction sequences grounded in cognitive learning theory.

### **Geometry 360° Virtual Tour — Peabody Hall, UNC, UNC Chapel Hill 2025**

*Educational Media Designer*

- Produced an immersive 360° educational video situating geometry concepts (Pythagorean theorem, parallel lines, similar triangles) within real architectural spaces for grades 6–10 learners.
- Designed to make abstract mathematical ideas spatially and experientially accessible.

### **CodeCracker — Educational Game, Cosmic Soup Ltd., Dhaka 2023–Present**

*Game Designer & Developer*

- Designed and developed a game teaching C programming fundamentals; engaged by 2,000+ high school students in Bangladesh.
- Shortlisted for the ICT Idea Grant by the Ministry of ICT, Bangladesh.

### **Ministry of Education, Bangladesh — Remote Learning Initiative, Dhaka 2021–2023**

*Project Lead & Creative Director (contracted via Dreamer Donkey Ltd.)*

- Led production of hundreds of curriculum-aligned educational video lessons for elementary and middle school learners across Bangladesh, coordinating educators, videographers, and curriculum specialists.
- Collaborated with government officials and subject-matter experts to translate national curriculum standards into engaging, evidence-based distance learning media.

### **Hatey Lekha — Youth Arts & Media Initiative, Dhaka 2024–Present**

*Founder & Cultural Initiative Lead*

- Founded an arts and culture initiative integrating audiovisual production, music, and publication into community-based programming for underserved youth.
- Under Hatey Lekha, launched Payntara — a youth-focused micro-OTT platform — providing hands-on filmmaking, storytelling, and media production workshops to young creators, connecting participants with professional tools and mentorship.

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### **Bangladesh Cinema and Television Institute (BCTI), Dhaka 2023–2025**

*Senior Instructor — Graduate Level*

- Designed and delivered graduate-level courses in World Film History I & II and Advanced Screenplay Writing for cohorts of emerging filmmakers.
- Mentored student film productions from concept through final cut; provided structured feedback on narrative, direction, and post-production craft.
- Contributed to curriculum redesign as a member of the Syllabus Review Committee (2024–25).

### **Jagannath University, Department of Film & Television, Dhaka 2022–2025**

*Adjunct Faculty — Undergraduate & Graduate Level*

- Taught six courses spanning film history, direction, screenplay writing, music video production, and literary adaptation.

- Developed course materials, designed assessment rubrics, and guided practical productions from pre-production through final delivery.

## ENTREPRENEURSHIP

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**Cosmic Soup Ltd., Dhaka 2023–Present**

*Founder & Managing Director*

- Lead strategic planning, product development, and business growth for a startup operating at the intersection of gaming, SaaS, and educational technology.
- Developed Rushpath, an edtech game platform shortlisted for the ICT Idea Grant (Ministry of ICT, Bangladesh), and Kancha, an agro-market platform connecting smallholder farmers with retailers.

**GEONICS, Dhaka 2013–2022**

*Founder & Head of Creatives*

- Founded and led a media production company delivering TVCs, documentaries, and television productions for corporate and government clients across nearly a decade.
- Managed end-to-end production: talent acquisition, client relations, creative direction, and quality assurance.

## CREATIVE & INDEPENDENT MEDIA WORK (SELECTED)

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### *Narrative & Fiction*

**Badhonhara — Feature Film, Dhaka 2024–Present**

*Screenplay Writer — Pre-Production*

- Writing the screenplay for a biographical feature film on legendary Bengali poets Kazi Nazrul Islam and Jibananda Das.

**bokjon hokjhok — Feature Film, Black Mirror Films, Dhaka 2024–Present**

*Screenplay Writer & Director*

- Writing and directing this feature film, overseeing narrative development, visual design, and production coordination.

**Khoka — Animation Series, Mars Solutions Ltd., Dhaka 2023–2024**

*Screenplay Writer & Creative Producer*

- Developed the screenplay and co-led production of this animation series, shaping visual and audio design throughout.

**'Who Killed the Father' — Docu-Fiction, Dhaka 2024–2025**

*Creative Producer*

- Oversaw narrative structure, production coordination, and editorial direction for a docu-fiction on Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, the founding father of Bangladesh.

**Bildakini — Feature Film, Data Solutions, Dhaka 2021–2023**

*Screenplay Writer & Creative Producer*

- Developed the screenplay and co-led production of this national film grant-winning feature film, shaping visual and audio design throughout.

**Laal Moroger Jhuti — Feature Film, Pandulipi Karkhana, Dhaka 2021–2022**

*Post-Production Supervisor — National Award-Winning Film*

- Oversaw editing, sound design, color grading, and DCP output, ensuring creative consistency and technical excellence throughout post-production.

### *Commissioned & Documentary Work*

**ATC Day — Docu-Fiction, Bangladesh Civil Aviation Authority 2024**

*Director & Producer*

- Directed and produced a commissioned docu-fiction for the official Air Traffic Control Day celebration of the Bangladesh Civil Aviation Authority.

**Health Awareness Video Series (8 Episodes), Ministry of Health, Bangladesh 2022–2023**

*Director & Producer*

- Produced eight public health awareness videos commissioned by the Bangladesh Ministry of Health for national broadcast and community outreach.

**Promotional Film — Dubai International Trade Summit, Teletalk Bangladesh 2022–2023**

*Director & Producer*

- Directed a promotional film commissioned by Teletalk Bangladesh (state-owned telecom) for representation at the Dubai International Trade Summit.

#### **TVC — Puriva Rice Bran Oil, Dhaka 2018–2019**

*Director & Producer*

- Directed and produced a television commercial for Puriva Rice Bran Oil, managing full production from concept through broadcast delivery.

#### **CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS**

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Dash, S. (2025). From Instruction to Interaction: Designing an Embodied, AI-Supported Learning Ecology. Poster session and proceedings paper presented at the Society for Information Technology & Teacher Education (SITE) International Conference 2025.

#### **PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & CERTIFICATIONS**

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Articulate Storyline Essential Training | Introduction to Virtual Reality (Coursera / Goldsmiths, University of London) | AI for Business Analysis | Statistics Foundations | Project Management Foundations | Negotiation Foundations | Film Appreciation Course (Film and Television Institute of India, Pune) | CITI Research Ethics Training

#### **SKILLS**

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**eLearning & Authoring Tools:** Articulate 360 (Storyline & Rise), Figma, Adobe Animate, Adobe Premiere Pro, Adobe Photoshop, Final Draft

**Immersive Media & XR:** 360-Video Production, AR/VR Prototyping, XR Learning Environment Design

**Data Analysis & Visualization:** R, Python, Flourish, Qualtrics, Learning Analytics, Interaction Analysis

**Research Methods:** Design-Based Research, Qualitative Video Analysis, Systematic Literature Review, Empirical Study Design

**Film & Media Production:** Screenwriting, Film Direction, Post-Production Supervision, Sound Design, Cinematography, Studio Infrastructure Design

**Instructional Practice:** Curriculum Design, Lesson Planning, Workshop Facilitation, Assessment Design, Research-to-Practice Translation

**Leadership & Management:** Project Management, Stakeholder Communication, Strategic Planning, Cross-functional Team Coordination, Startup Operations

**Languages:** Bengali (Native), English (Fluent — C1)

#### **PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS**

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Screenwriters Association (SWA), Mumbai, India — Member since 2019

Bangladesh Short Film Forum (BSFF), Dhaka — Member since 2021